ROOTED IN STYLE

Is styling the missing tool a modern homeowner needs? Meet the stylist who skipped the corporate ladder to build a creative empire on his own terms

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Photographs by MANISH KUMAR PHOTOGRAPHY- DELHI



Dressed in attire that gracefully screams casual cool, Raahul Kukreja truly embodies effortless chic. He's a far cry from the Hindi-medium, Alwar-born draughtsman who bought design magazines at the local railway station. The popular interior stylist known for breathing life into any space traded the predictable for the personal, launching a studio that serves as both a creative laboratory and a tribute to his textile-heritage roots. His journey is a beautiful lesson in intuition and grit.

Sanctuary for the Soul

Located two hours from the frantic pace of Delhi, Kukreja's studio in Alwar is a deliberate escape. While he has an office in Gurgaon, this space is special. "The soul connects over there," he explains. For Kukreja, the commute is a way to decouple from the noise and focus purely on the craft of styling, proving that geographic distance doesn't mean a loss of relevance.



Making a Name

How does a stylist with no connections make a mark in an industry he knows no one? Thirteen years ago, Kukreja arrived in Delhi as a "lost guy" who spoke no English and lacked formal design training. He built his reputation through a two-fold strategy: connecting with photographers (the gatekeepers of visual aesthetics) and using Instagram as a personal manifesto. By the end of the pandemic, a wave of new designers sought his professional lift to give their debut projects an edge.

Stylist vs Designer

Kukreja is clear about the distinction between his work and traditional architecture. "You need a designer for the civil work